Bantiger IT Forensics AG
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Bern, 25 February 2026

INDEPENDENT TECHNICAL ASSESSMENT - PROJECT COMPASS GENERAL LEDGER INCIDENT

1. Instructions and Independence

I, Dr. Elena Marti, born 3 March 1975, residing at Scheibenstrasse 12, 3014 Bern, was instructed by Zytglogge Praezisionsinstrumente AG to assess the technical cause of the General Ledger incident of 29-30 November 2025. I hold a doctorate in computer science and have worked in forensic IT assessment for financial and manufacturing systems for over fifteen years. I confirm that I have no financial or personal interest in the outcome of this dispute, that I have not previously been engaged by either party, and that this report reflects my independent professional opinion.

2. Documents and Data Reviewed

I have reviewed: the Master Services Agreement and Statement of Work dated 14 May 2024; the Steering Committee minutes of 29 August and 14 November 2025; the General Ledger application and database logs for the period 28 to 30 November 2025, extracted from the Claimant's production environment; the backup appliance's diagnostic and snapshot logs; the incident log kept contemporaneously by Mr. Broennimann; and the Teams channel export for the Go-Live weekend.

3. Technical Background

The System's cutover process migrates journal batches from a staging database into the General Ledger using a batch-import routine. A correctly designed batch-import routine should be idempotent, meaning that re-running the same batch, whether deliberately or as a result of a retry after a transient failure, should not create duplicate postings. Idempotency is ordinarily achieved by recording a unique key for each imported batch and rejecting any batch carrying a key already recorded as processed.

4. Summary of Findings

The system logs show that duplicate postings to the General Ledger first appeared at approximately 23:40 on 29 November 2025. The logs record a transient network timeout during the import of journal batch JB-0417 at 23:38, followed by an automatic retry at 23:39 that resubmitted the same batch. No idempotency key check rejected the resubmission, and the batch was posted a second time, corrupting the opening trial balance. The backup appliance's most recent snapshot, dated 28 November 2025, was separately found to be corrupted at the file-system level and could not be used to restore the ledger; this appears to be an unrelated, pre-existing fault in the appliance's scheduled snapshot job.

5. Contributing Factors

The compressed data-quality testing window following the delayed delivery of the legacy master data extract reduced the time available to validate migrated journal batches before cutover, and I have considered whether this contributed to the incident. Having reviewed the content of batch JB-0417, I do not find that its substantive data was itself defective; the duplicate posting resulted from the batch being submitted twice, not from an error within the batch. In my assessment, the principal and proximate cause of the incident was accordingly the absence of an idempotency safeguard in the batch-import routine, which is a design and testing responsibility of the implementing contractor rather than of the client.

6. Conclusion

The incident was, in my opinion, primarily attributable to a defect in the cutover software - the absence of an idempotency safeguard against batch resubmission - rather than to the condition of the data supplied by the Client.

Dr. Elena Marti

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